Reflexive AI

Workgroup · Session #1 · results

Reflexive AI Workgroup

Session results: what participants said about human-centered AI, which themes they chose to explore, and how they imagined failure, prevention and monitoring for each.

// SESSION

November 2, 2026 · Online · Session #1

16 participants, including 2 facilitators. Formats: 1-2-4-All, dot voting on themes, and a Premortem with Shift & Share on four themes. The group worked in English; the raw data contains the full session transcript.

SESSION DETAILS

FACILITATORS	Christiaan Verwijs and Barry Overeem
DATE	November 2, 2026
PARTICIPANTS	16 (including 2 facilitators)
LOCATION	Online
INFORMED CONSENT	From all participants (available at Lucid Institute)
TRANSCRIPTION	Claude AI (verified by Christiaan Verwijs)
ANONYMIZATION	Christiaan Verwijs
RAW DATA	Session transcript on GitHub

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OPENING EXERCISE

1-2-4-All

“What does human-centered AI look like to you? How would you explain it to someone else?”

GROUP	#	RESPONSE
1	1	Human empowerment ([Doug Engelbart])
1	2	Not using people as accountability sinks
1	3	Create centaurs, not reverse centaurs *Note: written as "Entaur's"; the entry ends with "="*
2	4	Respects basic needs: autonomy in decisions, competence, connection
2	5	Makes people not just faster → supports learning and judgement instead of replacing them (feeling more capable, and feeling should be better)
2	6	Mutual trust
2	7	A valuable addition for the things I don't like / don't want to do → more time for meaningful work, for better work and a better world
2	8	Should not substitute people, because we need meaning and something useful to do
2	9	Should support more exchange between humans, because AI takes over less valuable work
2	10	Understand the borders of AI
3	11	Putting the human in the lead (and not in the loop) → take the driver's seat
3	12	Know when and how to apply it
3	13	Be critical
3	14	"Fits like a glove"
3	15	Collaboration at eye/screen level – no distinction between human and AI employee
3	16	AI needs to know what I want and delivers results that fit
3	17	We use AI to make our daily work more engaging and meaningful, and to make us more competent and autonomous (self-determination theory)
3	18	What can help to improve relatedness (we can easily relate less to other human beings because we interact with AI directly)
4	19	It starts with development & training: developing AI that is centered around the needs of users
4	20	"Not losing who we are" ([participant])
4	21	Also defining when we don't need AI (AI leads, AI sandwich, no AI support)
4	22	Human in the loop *Note: listed under "practical, what does it mean?"*
4	23	Looking at AI not as a threat, but as an opportunity *Note: listed under "practical, what does it mean?"*

OPENING EXERCISE (CONTINUED)

1-2-4-All

GROUP	#	RESPONSE
4	24	Communication about AI from leadership *Note: listed under "practical, what does it mean?"*
4	25	Enabling leadership to not just look at the cost side of things *Note: listed under "practical, what does it mean?"*

This group worked in English. Where participants wrote several ideas in one cell, these are split into separate rows. The full transcript is in the raw data.

THEME SELECTION

Dot voting for themes

Participants voted on the sub-themes they wanted to explore further.

SUB-THEME	THEME	VOTES
Meaningful Work	People & Work	6
Workforce & Learning	People & Work	5
Sustainability	Boundaries & Duties	5
Review & Adaptation	Direction & Control	4
Purpose & Strategy	Direction & Control	3
Risk & Boundaries	Boundaries & Duties	3
Human Agency	Direction & Control	3
Governance & Ethics	Direction & Control	3
Work Design	People & Work	3
Participation	Culture & Voice	3
Quality & Oversight	People & Work	2
Power & Dynamics	Culture & Voice	2
Questioning Culture	Culture & Voice	1
Legal & Compliance	Boundaries & Duties	1
IP & Data Ownership	Boundaries & Duties	1
Communication	Culture & Voice	1

Sorted by dot votes, highest first. Participants formed groups around four sub-themes for the Premortem: Meaningful Work, Workforce & Learning, Sustainability, and Risk & Boundaries.

PREMORTEM · SHIFT & SHARE

Meaningful Work

1 · FAILURE MODE

"Imagine what it would look like if AI was not human-centered for this theme. What would happen, or not happen?"

#	RESPONSE
1	Humans will just review what AI does
2	AI takes all the challenging work, so humans will not be relevant anymore
3	AI takes over all the creative and meaningful work
4	We humans stop evolving and learning
5	Through AI we lose our professional identity
6	Increased anxiety and stress at work because of the sense of being replaceable
7	Effort feels pointless (why should I try if AI does it better?) – lack of motivation
8	We develop and use AI technology that doesn't necessarily serve real human needs
9	AI provides answers and recommendations, but the underlying processes are not transparent. As a result, people cannot fully understand, question, or verify how decisions are made
10	Risk of losing trust, control, and human autonomy *Note: follows from #9*
11	Confidence will be lost: "I can't do it without AI"

2 · PREVENTION / ACTIONS

"What can we do to prevent undesirable outcomes from occurring and encourage desirable outcomes to happen?"

#	RESPONSE
12	Explicit delegation and role definitions to clarify the boundaries between AI and human tasks *Note: written in response to #2*
13	Rethink job and role design
14	Involve employees in defining those new roles in the AI era
15	Accept a slower pace to keep the human learning loop alive
16	Design the whole system to avoid AI taking the most impactful work
17	Define specific AI competencies for every system around us (education, organizations, government)
18	What happens if AI is not available? "Disaster & recovery" policies
19	Make failure part of our culture, since it's part of the learning process we need as humans. AI also makes mistakes

Meaningful Work

2 · PREVENTION / ACTIONS (CONTINUED)

#	RESPONSE
20	Establish "AI off" moments as part of our learning and thinking process

3 · MONITORING

> “What indicators, signals, or evidence can be tracked, monitored, or audited to avoid undesirable outcomes and encourage desirable ones?”

#	RESPONSE
21	Intrinsic motivation factors, and engagement surveys
22	Decreasing interest in software engineering because of AI
23	Evaluate time people spend reviewing work done by AI instead of doing the work themselves
24	Number of questions asked to AI that could be answered with some human reflection

PREMORTEM · SHIFT & SHARE

Workforce & Learning

1 · FAILURE MODE

"Imagine what it would look like if AI was not human-centered for this theme. What would happen, or not happen?"

#	RESPONSE
1	Without learning, there is no human center
2	People are mandated to use AI in pre-determined & rigid ways, divorced from the actual work needed to support the customer
3	In Tayloristic & Neo-Welchist organizations this is already happening
4	The outcome is staff frustration, disengagement, loss of skills & staff disgruntlement *Note: follows from #2*
5	This will lead to workplace unrest
6	Management lays people off, revenue falls, customers desert the firm, and the economy tanks
7	Reverse centaurism

2 · PREVENTION / ACTIONS

"What can we do to prevent undesirable outcomes from occurring and encourage desirable outcomes to happen?"

#	RESPONSE
8	Allow staff to discover among themselves how best to use automation to benefit the customer and solve work problems
9	Allow staff to dialogue with management on how end-to-end processes need to adapt, and on what is not wise or possible to automate
10	Firm-wide facilitated dialogue in an open spirit, where management is open to learning from staff & staff is key
11	Staff understanding the larger business environment & committing to transparency
12	Ensure through training that critical thinking, quality and skills are maintained
13	Enable unions where none exist, to balance worker power with management
14	Staff must have ownership of the work & the standards
15	Disaggregation & leaderless work may need to be negotiated
16	Mindset is key: leaders must role-model & encourage the mindset change, beginning with themselves
17	Feedback with Radical Candor in a psychologically safe environment. There is a big role for management here

Workforce & Learning

3 · MONITORING

"What indicators, signals, or evidence can be tracked, monitored, or audited to avoid undesirable outcomes and encourage desirable ones?"

#	RESPONSE
18	Staff disengagement
19	Loss of customer retention
20	Slower throughput (product & organizational)
21	Loss of quality
22	Falling revenues
23	Even social unrest, as jobs are lost when businesses shed employees due to lower profits

PREMORTEM · SHIFT & SHARE

Sustainability

1 · FAILURE MODE

"Imagine what it would look like if AI was not human-centered for this theme. What would happen, or not happen?"

#	RESPONSE
1	Huge economic gap
2	Huge knowledge gap
3	People feeling threatened by AI
4	Because of e.g. data centers: CO2 emissions rise
5	People will be without water and houses *Note: continues the data center example in #4*
6	Ground and air polluted *Note: continues the data center example in #4*
7	People have no say in what happens
8	In a dark scenario, AI might destroy our planet (by design), driven by tech oligarchs
9	Injustice & exploitation of natural resources & people

2 · PREVENTION / ACTIONS

"What can we do to prevent undesirable outcomes from occurring and encourage desirable outcomes to happen?"

#	RESPONSE
10	Engage the narrative: give people the feeling they are in control
11	Help create & spread a narrative that is easy to understand and grounded in evidence
12	Set-up in your organization → think about when you use AI and when not
13	Help people make a choice when they use AI (on the user & tool side)
14	An indicator of sustainability / resource usage for each AI "tool"
15	Pay for the damage of using AI
16	Appropriateness principle when it comes to the usage of AI
17	Don't chase the next, even more capable model
18	Capacity building: training for low-maturity users + a narrative on the impact of AI
19	Mandatory reporting on AI usage
20	Useful & mindful consumption: choosing sustainable AI providers (e.g. Ecosia AI)

Sustainability

3 · MONITORING

"What indicators, signals, or evidence can be tracked, monitored, or audited to avoid undesirable outcomes and encourage desirable ones?"

#	RESPONSE
21	Capture damage costs: token costs shown as an equivalent in resources/cost (e.g., trees) → externalities / damage costs
22	A signal before AI is used, asking the user e.g. whether they really want to create this picture, or search for other existing material instead
23	Look into the distribution of planned data centers (location, size)
24	Economic opportunities vs. job loss (demonstrating to companies: this is what you expected to achieve, this is the actual result)
25	AI literacy / maturity

PREMORTEM · SHIFT & SHARE

Risk & Boundaries

1 · FAILURE MODE

"Imagine what it would look like if AI was not human-centered for this theme. What would happen, or not happen?"

#	RESPONSE
1	Right now, not working in a human-centered way → incidents that show no proper risk management is happening
2	Misuse of AI (excessive, non-regulated use; confusion of responsibility)
3	Not using AI (strict regulations → employees start secretly using AI, which can get out of control)
4	Misunderstanding of how work results or feedback were achieved (e.g., HR uses AI to select applicants – no transparency concerning rejections)

2 · PREVENTION / ACTIONS

"What can we do to prevent undesirable outcomes from occurring and encourage desirable outcomes to happen?"

#	RESPONSE
5	Stay adaptive: be flexible regarding the needs users have, new learnings and new guidelines → monitor and adapt
6	Find a balance between giving people the time to get used to tools/systems, while being aware that the first choice may not always be the best *Note: elaborates on #5*
7	Don't choose the cheapest/easiest/best-known tool/system → analyze BEFORE what people need
8	Sanction shadow/parallel systems (i.e., how do we cope if people use parallel systems?) → should also be set by the government
9	Build psychological safety (to avoid finger-pointing)
10	Implement a reporting system without fear of repercussions (i.e., where can I report if something goes wrong?)
11	Awareness training on what it means in daily life; be aware of risks
12	Developers should also consider safety/boundaries (e.g., AI tells you when you ask a question outside the boundaries for this organization: "this is not going to happen because of this and that policy we have at this organization")

Risk & Boundaries

3 · MONITORING

"What indicators, signals, or evidence can be tracked, monitored, or audited to avoid undesirable outcomes and encourage desirable ones?"

#	RESPONSE
13	% of AI users (do people use the company AI at all, or do they feel it isn't helpful?) – caveat: is more always better?
14	Number of times we did a risk analysis before implementing something
15	Measure psychological safety
16	Survey that asks "Do you think our AI is helpful?", feedback on current use, preferences
17	To what extent people are aware whether and how they're using AI
18	Data leaks
19	Complaints by customers

ACTION RESEARCH

Follow-up actions

We do not publish the follow-up actions identified by participants as part of the action research cycle. This data may convey personal or company-sensitive details. This data is only available to them and to the research team

SESSION NOTES

Changes to the default format

- The 1-2-4-ALL for the definition of human-centered AI was simplified to 1-[small group]-ALL.
- The Shift & Share was 1 round instead of 3 due to time constraints. This means that participants did not get to see most of the other outcomes nor provide feedback on it.